

LUNGTEN DORJI

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Natural Resources and Biodiversity Specialist with over 9 years of professional experience in forest landscape management, biodiversity conservation, climate resilience, and environmental planning in Bhutan. Proven track record in leading nationally significant conservation programs, managing donor-funded projects, conducting environmental assessments, and supporting policy development. Experience supporting biodiversity and environmental management components of World Bank, Asian Development Bank, GEF, WWF, and other internationally financed development initiatives. Skilled in project design, implementation, stakeholder engagement, monitoring and evaluation, and applied ecological research.

SELECTED CAREER ACHIEVEMENT

- Led development of Bhutan's national Conservation Action Plans for Red Panda and Golden Langur (2025–2034).
- Managed and implemented conservation, biodiversity monitoring, and natural resource management projects exceeding USD 2 million in cumulative value (since 2024) from international donors, development partners, and government agencies.
- Technical specialist for biodiversity management planning under World Bank, European Investment Bank, and Asian Development Bank-supported infrastructure projects in Bhutan requiring biodiversity net gain strategy.
- Secured competitive international funding from WWF, Panthera, Pangolin Crisis Fund, Fisheries Conservation Foundation, and other development partners.
- Published scientific research and technical reports supporting national conservation policy and environmental management.
- Led or contributed to biodiversity management planning, environmental assessments, and safeguard-related activities for infrastructure and renewable energy investments supported by the World Bank, Asian Development Bank, European Investment Bank, and national development agencies.

DEVELOPMENT FINANCE AND MDB EXPERIENCE

- Technical Specialist for biodiversity management planning associated with World Bank-supported transport infrastructure projects.
- Chair, Technical Working Group for Biodiversity Management Plans for ADB-supported renewable energy projects.
- Led biodiversity assessments and environmental management planning for hydropower, transmission line, road, and solar energy investments.
- Supported environmental safeguard compliance, stakeholder consultations, biodiversity mitigation planning, and implementation monitoring.
- Worked with government agencies, consultants, development partners, and local communities to integrate biodiversity conservation and climate resilience into development investments.
- Supported integration of biodiversity conservation, ecosystem services, climate resilience, and nature-based solutions into infrastructure and natural resource management investments.

WORK EXPERIENCES

Senior Forestry Officer

January 1st, 2024, to present

Nature Conservation Division, Department of Forests and Park Services of Bhutan

Key Achievements:

- Led Bhutan's national biodiversity monitoring and species conservation programs across protected areas and biological corridors, generating evidence to support conservation policy and management decisions.
- Led preparation of national species conservation action plans and technical guidance documents supporting environmental policy and management.
- Managed multiple donor-funded projects focused on biodiversity conservation, ecosystem resilience, and community-based natural resource management.
- Supported biodiversity integration into infrastructure, hydropower, renewable energy, and transport development projects.
- Represented the Department in technical working groups involving national agencies, development partners, and international conservation organizations.

Forestry Technical Officer

2017 – 2023 (01/01/2017 – 31/12/2023)

Wangchuck Centennial National Park, Department of Forests and Park Services of Bhutan

Key achievements:

- Developed and executed projects on biodiversity conservation enhancing livelihood of yak herding communities
- Initiated project to reduce poaching and providing alternative livelihood to indigenous poaching community
- Compiled, analyzed, and interpreted data from experiments, preparing detailed reports, charts, and technical documentation to present findings.
- Contributed to conservation and biodiversity research by aiding in species identification, conducting population assessments, and participating in ecological investigations.
- Assisted in the monitoring of environmental and hydrological factors, supporting research on watershed management and the effects of climate change.
- Initiated formulation of community conservation committee (e.g., snow leopard conservation committee)
- Supervised field rangers on conservation of biodiversity, antipoaching patrolling and research

Consultancy work executed:

KAP Survey on Biodiversity Conservation and Ecotourism Development 2022, Department of Tourism /UNDP, Thimphu: Bhutan

ACADEMIC QUALIFICATIONS

Ph.D. in Biological Sciences: School of Biological Sciences, University of Southampton 2020-2024. Research focus: biodiversity monitoring, wildlife population ecology, conservation planning, and human dimensions of conservation.

M.Sc. Forestry

Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy (affiliated to Forest Research Institute), Dehradun, Uttarakhand India 2014 – 2016

Certificate in Public Administration: Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration, India, August to December 2014

B.Sc. Life Sciences

Sherubtse College, Kanglung, Royal University of Bhutan, Tashigang Bhutan
2011-2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Natural Resource Management
- Forest Landscape Conservation
- Biodiversity Assessment and Monitoring
- Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA/ESIA)
- Biodiversity Management Planning
- Climate Change Adaptation
- Nature-Based Solutions
- Project Design and Management
- Monitoring and Evaluation
- Stakeholder Engagement and Policy Dialogue
- GIS and Spatial Analysis (ArcGIS, QGIS)
- Statistical Ecology (R, Occupancy, SECR, RSF, REM)

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

- Dorji, L., Doncaster, C. P., Wong, W.-M., Shrestha, R., Tenzin, K., Glover-Kapfer, P., Grassman, L., Jr., & Wearn, O. R. (2026). *Optimizing camera trap placement for felid density estimation: Comparing trail-based and random deployments*. *Biological Conservation*, 321, 111987. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biocon.2026.111987>
- J Zhang et al. (2026). Understanding the consequences of intermittent and repeated air exposure events on Bluegill in the context of recreational fishing, *North American Journal of Fisheries Management*, 2026;, vqaf129, <https://doi.org/10.1093/najfmt/vqaf129>
- Sherub, K., Thurnheer, S., Lüthi, M., Marques, V., Lyet, A., Dhendup, T., ... & Pellissier, L. (2026). Comparing Watershed-Based eDNA Sampling and Camera Trapping for Assessing Mammal Diversity in North-Western Bhutan. *Environmental DNA*, 8(1), e70243.
- NCD (2025): **Conservation Action Plan for Golden Langur** in Bhutan (2025 to 2034). Department of Forests and Park Services, Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources, Royal Government of Bhutan. Taba, Thimphu: ISBN 978-99980-725-0-3
- NCD (2025): **Conservation Action Plan for Red Panda** in Bhutan (2025 to 2034). Department of Forests and Park Services, Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources, Royal Government of Bhutan. Taba, Thimphu: ISBN 978-99980-725-1-0
- Dorji, L. (2024). **Enhancing wild-felid conservation by resolving biases in population-density estimation and evaluating human perceptions of felids** (Doctoral dissertation, University of Southampton). <https://eprints.soton.ac.uk/489814/>
- NCD (2024). Technical Report on **Biodiversity Monitoring Grids** of Bhutan. Department of Forests and Park Services, Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources, Royal Government of Bhutan. Taba, Thimphu.
- Dorji, Lungten et al (2018). **Field Study on Musk Deer and its conservation strategies in Wangchuck Centennial National Park**. Department of Forest and Park Services, Ministry of Agriculture and Forest, Nasiphel, Bumthang Bhutan: ISBN-978-99936-678-9-6.

AWARDS

- International Elephant Foundations Grant for Year 2026
- Travel Grant, to attend Seminar on Wildlife Genetics in Thailand. Funded by Felidae Conservation Foundation, USA (2025).
- Visiting Research Fellow for 2024 at Queen's University Biological station, Ontario, Canada. Funded by Fisheries Conservation Foundation, USA, June – August 2024.
- Travel Grant, World Wildlife Fund Bhutan Program (2023)
- Small Cat Action Fund, Panthera International, USA (3 times, 2022, 2023 and 2025)
- Bursary for Student Conference on Conservation Science, University of Cambridge (2022)
- Research grant, World Wildlife Fund Bhutan Program 2022.
- University of Southampton Studentship January 2020 to February 2024.
- KAPLAN fellowship, Panthera International, USA (2020)
- WWF practice innovation grant, World Wide Fund for Nature, Switzerland (2019 -2020)
- Sabin Snow Leopard Grant, Panthera International, USA (2018 – 2019)
- V.S. Rao Price for Academic Excellence 2016. Indian Forest Service Probationers Convocation April 30, 2016.
- Presidents medal for Overall Academic Topper B.Sc. Life Science Sherubtse College

TRAININGS & WORKSHOPS

- Integrated Tiger Habitat Conservation Program (ITHCP) Tiger and Prey Research and Monitoring Training Workshop in Bangkok, 2025. Funded by IUCN Switzerland.
- Poster presentation at Student's Conference on Conservation Science, University of Cambridge, 2022.
- Boot Camp on Wildlife Study Design and Data Analysis, conducted by Friends of Nature Nepal and Biodiversity Conservation Society of Sarawak of Malaysia in Katmandu, Nepal, 2018.
- Attended training on Policy Analysis from 14th -25th November 2017 conducted by Institute of Management Studies Limited, in Thimphu Bhutan.
- Training on Development of Business Plan for Forestry Sector conducted by Ugyen Wangchuck Institute for Conservation and Environmental Research from 22nd to 26th May 2017 in Thimphu, Bhutan.
- Training Expedition on Coastal & Marine biodiversity and protected area management (organized by GIZ Germany, Earthwatch Institute & Andaman and Nicobar Forest and Environment Department), 2016
- Management Development Program (Indian Institute of Management Lucknow, Uttarpradesh India), 2016
- Conservation Management Planning using GIS, Arbonaut, Finland, 2015.
- Professional training on importance and management of NGO (organized by Amity School of Natural Resource & Sustainable Development and Amity School of Global Warming & Ecological Studies, Amity University, Greater Noida Uttarpradesh India), 2015.

VOLUNTARY ACTIVITIES

- Volunteer teacher for chemistry, Zhemgang Central School, Zhemgang Bhutan (2 months, 2021)
- Volunteer for distribution of essential items for COVID-19 lockdown in Bumtang district, Bumtang Bhutan (2020)

TECHNICAL WORKING GROUP

- Chair of Technical Working Group for Biodiversity Management Plan, Neyra Amari Hydropower Project (404 MW).
- Chair of TWG, Biodiversity Management Plan, Wobthang Solar Power Project funded by Asian Development Bank
- Technical and Biodiversity Specialist for Biodiversity Management Plan, Gelephu – Taraythang Highway, funded by World Bank
- Program Specialist for Masters in Conservation Biology, Royal University of Bhutan

SELECTED PROJECTS EXPERIENCE

Project / Initiative	Role	Donor / Partner	Value (USD)
Development of Cohabitation Strategy for Gelephu–Taraythang Highway and Elephant Landscapes	Technical Lead	World Bank ACCESS Project	19,000 (Project Portfolio: 5M)
Biodiversity Management Plan for Wobthang Solar Power Project	Chair, Technical Working Group	Asian Development Bank	15,000
Biodiversity Assessment for Sunkosh Hydropower Project (4060 MW)	Technical Lead	Druk Green Power Corporation	34,883
Biodiversity Assessment for Yurmochu Hydropower Project	Technical Lead	Druk Green Power Corporation	19,767
WildinSync Bhutan: eDNA for National Biodiversity Monitoring and Reporting	Project Lead	WWF Bhutan	4,27,000
Preventing Extirpation of Musk Deer in Bhutan	Project Lead	WWF Switzerland	4,38,000
Bhutan Wild Felid Health Project	Project Lead	Felidae Conservation Fund, USA	2,19,000
Tiger Impact Certification of Tiger Range Villages	Project Lead	WWF Bhutan	150000
Biodiversity Monitoring of Bhutan	National Lead	Global Environment Facility (GEF)	156000
Edge Species Conservation Project (Snow Leopard & Red Panda)	Project Lead	WWF Korea	52,000

LANGUAGES

- English – Fluent
- Nepali – Fluent (spoken and professional working proficiency)
- Dzongkha – Native
- Hindi – Working proficiency

REFERENCES

- Tshering Dhendup, Chief Forestry Officer, Nature Conservation Division. Email: tsheringdhendup@moenr.gov.bt; phone: +97517300700
- C.Patrick Doncaster, Professor in Ecology, School of Biological Sciences, University of Southampton, United Kingdom; email: cpd@soton.ac.uk

- Sonam Wangdi, Chief Program Officer, Bhutan Trust Fund for Environment Conservation, email: sonamwangdi@bhutantrustfund.bt ; phone: +975-17110006